PHISHING: PAUSE BEFORE YOU CLICK

- A 30-minute staff awareness session
- Greenfield College · Fictional training scenario

WHY THIS MATTERS

- One rushed action can expose an account or release money
- Phishing targets people, not just computers
- Anyone can be targeted

TODAY'S 30-MINUTE PLAN

- 5 min · Understand the attack
- 10 min · Spot the warning signs
- 5 min · Practise and report
- 7 min · Passwords + MFA
- 3 min · Recap and quiz

WHAT IS PHISHING?

- A message designed to trick you into taking an unsafe action
- Common goals: steal sign-in details, obtain money, or deliver malware
- It can arrive by email, text, phone or collaboration app

THE PHISHING PLAYBOOK

- Pretend to be trusted
- Create urgency, fear, curiosity or secrecy
- Ask for a click, sign-in, payment, file or code
- Make verification feel inconvenient

CHECK THE SENDER

- Read the full email address—not just the display name
- Look for misspellings or unexpected domains
- A familiar name is not proof of identity
- When in doubt, verify using a known contact method

CHECK THE LINK

- Pause before opening links
- Preview the destination where your device allows
- Watch for look-alike or unrelated domains
- Open known services using a bookmark or typed address

READ THE REQUEST + TONE

- Unexpected money, gift cards or bank-detail changes = stop
- Threats and short deadlines are pressure tactics
- Requests to bypass normal approval are a major warning
- Never share passwords or one-time codes

UNEXPECTED FILES & DELIVERY NOTICES

- Were you expecting this file or parcel?
- Does the message identify a real order you recognise?
- Do not enable macros or sign in through an unexpected file
- Check delivery status through the carrier's official app/site

PERSONALISED DOESN'T MEAN TRUSTED

- Spear phishing is tailored to a person or role
- It may mention a meeting, project or colleague
- Personal detail can be copied or gathered
- Verify unusual requests through a separate channel

PRACTISE: SPOT THE RED FLAGS

- Who is really sending this?
- Where does the link go?
- What action is being requested?
- What pressure is being applied?
- How can you verify safely?

HOW TO REPORT SAFELY

- Do not reply, click, download or forward to colleagues
- Use the organisation's approved Report Phishing button or IT channel
- Include the message; preserve it as instructed by IT
- If you clicked or shared details, report immediately—no blame

PASSWORD MANAGERS: A SAFER KEY RING

- Creates and stores strong, unique passwords
- Fills the right password on the right site
- You remember one strong master password
- Use only an IT-approved manager; protect its recovery method

MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (MFA)

- A second proof of identity after your password
- For example: an authenticator prompt or security key
- A stolen password alone may not be enough
- Never approve an unexpected prompt or share a code

RECAP: PAUSE · CHECK · VERIFY · REPORT

- Pause when a message creates pressure
- Check sender, link, request and context
- Verify using a known, separate channel
- Report quickly—even if you clicked